

O God, in restless living

Text: Harry Emerson Fosdick, 1931

Music: Edward F. Rimbault, 1867

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The musical score is written for a four-part vocal choir (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) and piano accompaniment. It is in the key of B-flat major (two flats) and 2/2 time. The score is divided into four systems, each with a treble and bass staff. Chord symbols (I, V, vi, IV, I, IV, V, V⁷, ii, I, V, I, I, IV, iv, I, IV, iv, I, I, V⁷, I, V⁷, I) are placed above the treble staff to indicate the harmonic structure. The lyrics are written below the vocal staves, with four lines of text per system. The piano accompaniment is written in the bass staff, providing a harmonic and rhythmic foundation for the voices.

System 1: I V vi IV I IV V
1 O God in rest - less liv - ing we lose our spir - it's peace.
2 Teach us, be - yond our striv - ing, the rich re - wards of rest
3 Re - cep - tive make our spir - its, our need is to be still.
4 We grow not wise by strug - gling, we gain but things by strain.

System 2: V⁷ I V⁷ I ii I V I
Calm our un - wise con - fu - sion, bid thou our clam - or cease.
Who does not live se - rene - ly is nev - er deep - ly bless'd.
As dawn fades flick - 'ring can - dle, so dim our anx - ious will.
We cease to wa - ter gar - dens when comes thy plen - teous rain.

System 3: I IV iv I IV iv I
Let anx - ious hearts grow qui - et, like pools at eve - ning still,
O tran - quil, ra - diant Sun - light, bring thou our lives to flow'r,
Re - veal thy ra - diance through us, thine am - ple strength re - lease.
O, beau - ti - fy our spir - its in rest - ful - ness from strife,

System 4: I IV I V⁷ I V⁷ I
till thy re - flect - ed heav - ens all our spir - its fill
less wea - ried with our ef - fort, more a - ware of pow'r.
Not ours, but thine the tri - umph in the pow'r of peace.
en - rich our souls in se - cret with a - bun - dant life.